

GOVERNOR GENERALS AND VICEROYS

Name and Period	Description
Robert Clive 1757 to 1760 and 1765 to 1767	Key Events & Wars: Battle of Plassey (1757) - Battle of Buxar (1764). Key Reforms/Initiatives: First British Governor of Bengal Presidency.
Warren Hastings (1773-1785)	Key Events & Wars: Rohilla War (1774), First Maratha War (1775-1782) and Treaty of Salbai (1782), Second Mysore War (1780-1784) Key Reforms/Initiatives: Regulating Act of 1773, Act of 1781 (clarification of jurisdictional powers), Pitt's India Act of 1784, Foundation of Asiatic Society of Bengal (1784) Established Calcutta Madrasa [UPSC 2018] Administrative Reforms: Abolished the Dual System; revenue management taken over by the President and Council; Board of Revenue established; treasury moved to Calcutta; Nawab's allowance cut; payments to Emperor Shah Alam stopped. Revenue Reforms: Initiated five-year land revenue settlement; replaced corrupt Collectors; reverted to annual settlements favouring zamindars; aimed for centralization, leading to poor revenue collection. Judicial Reforms: Established Diwani and Faujdari Adalat; created a Supreme Court; jurisdiction conflicts persisted; codified Hindu and Muslim laws. Commercial Reforms: Reduced custom houses; standardised duties; regulated dastaks; protected weavers; fostered trade with Bhutan and Tibet.
Lord Cornwallis (1786-1793)	Key Events & Wars: Third Mysore War (1790-1792) - Treaty of Seringapatam (1792) Key Reforms/Initiatives: Cornwallis Code (1793); Permanent Settlement of Bengal (1793); Europeanisation of administrative machinery and introduction of civil services. Separated revenue from justice administration. Administrative Reforms: Europeanised administration; focused on capability and integrity; Abolished low wages and excessive perks; advocated for merit-based appointments. Separated commercial, judicial, and revenue services. Judicial Reforms: Reduced revenue districts from 35 to 23; Collectors gained magisterial powers. Established four circuit courts; finalised reforms as the Cornwallis Code in 1793. Police Reforms: Removed police power from Zamindars; empowered District Judges. Commercial Reforms: Addressed corruption; streamlined procurement through Commercial Residents. Ensured fair treatment for weavers and Indian labourers.
Sir John Shore (1793-1798)	Key Events & Wars: Battle of Kharda (1795) Key Reforms/Initiatives: Charter Act of 1793 (regulation of the East India Company).

Lord Wellesley (1798-1805)	Key Events & Wars: Fourth Mysore War (1799) - Second Anglo-Maratha War(1803-1805) and Treaty; Treaty of Bassein (1802) Key Reforms/Initiatives: Initiated Subsidiary Alliance; Nizam Ali of Hyderabad was the first to accept it (1798); Formed Madras Presidency; Wellesley established the Fort William College at Calcutta to train British civilians for administrative purposes in India. [UPSC 2020]
Sir George Barlow (1805-1807)	Key Events & Wars: Vellore Mutiny (1806)
Lord Minto I (1807-1813)	Key Events & Wars: Treaty of Amritsar with Ranjit Singh (1809)
Lord Hastings (1813-1823)	Key Events & Wars: Anglo-Nepal War (1814-1816) - Treaty of Sagauli (1816); Third Maratha War (1817-1819) - Treaty with Sindhia (1817) Key Reforms/Initiatives: Adopted interventionist policies; forced settlements on Peshwa and Scindia. Introduced Ryotwari settlement in Madras (1820).
Lord Amherst (1823-1828)	Key Events & Wars: First Burmese War (1824-1826); Capture of Bharatpur (1826)
Lord William Bentinck (1828-1835)	Key Events & Wars: Annexation of Mysore (1831); Annexation of Coorg (1834); Treaty with Ranjit Singh (1831) Note: Charter Act, 1833 designated the Governor General of Bengal as the Governor General of India. [UPSC 2023] Key Reforms/Initiatives: Suppression of Thuggee (1830), Charter Act of 1833, Introduced state railways and the Ganges Canal (1854), Regarded as the “Father of Modern Western Education in India.” Social Reforms: Abolition of Sati: Banned by the Bengal Sati Regulation (1829), Female Infanticide: Made illegal and punishable. Discrimination Removal: Charter Act (1833) allowed Indians to hold public office. Educational Reforms: Promoted English education; formed the Committee of Public Instruction. Endorsed Macaulay’s English medium recommendation. Established Calcutta Medical College (1835). Financial Reforms: Reduced military salaries; streamlined administration. Regularised opium trade; implemented revenue settlements; Achieved Rs. 1.5 million budget surplus. Administrative Reforms: Abolished Cornwallis provisions. Introduced local languages in lower courts; English in higher courts.
Lord Metcalfe (1835-1836)	Key Reforms/Initiatives: New press law removing restrictions on the press in India (1835). Known as the “Liberator of the Indian Press”.
Lord Auckland (1836-1842)	Key Events & Wars: First Afghan War (1838-1842); Death of Ranjit Singh (1839)
Lord Ellenborough (1842-1844)	Key Events & Wars: Annexation of Sindh (1843); War with Gwalior (1843)
Lord Hardinge I (1844-1848)	Key Events & Wars: First Anglo-Sikh War (1845-1846) - Treaty of Lahore (1846). Key Reforms/Initiatives: Social reforms against female infanticide and human sacrifice.

Lord Dalhousie (1848-1856)	Key Events & Wars: Second Anglo-Sikh War (1848-1849) - Annexation of Punjab (1849); Annexation of Lower Burma (1852) Key Reforms/Initiatives: Doctrine of Lapse, Ganges Canal (1854), Widow Remarriage Act (1856). Administrative Reforms: Appointed a Lieutenant Governor for Bengal, centralising administration. Designated commissioners for newly acquired territories. Military Reforms: Established Simla as the army headquarters; relocated troops by 1865. Increased the number of English soldiers; formed three new regiments. Integrated Sikh and Gurkha forces into the army. Educational Reforms: Approved the Thomsonian system for vernacular education in 1853. Implemented Wood's Despatch for educational expansion, including universities. Established examining universities in Calcutta, Madras, and Bombay. Railways, Telegraphs, and Postal Services: Initiated a nationwide railway network; first line completed in 1853. Established a Telegraph Department; extensive telegraph coverage; Enacted the Post Office Act of 1854 for organised postal services. Public Works Department: Created a specialised Public Works Department for infrastructure projects. Restored the Grand Trunk Road and initiated major irrigation projects. Trade: Advocated for free trade; facilitated British trade by expanding docks in major ports.
Lord Canning (1856-1862)	Key Events & Wars: Revolt of 1857; White Mutiny by European troops (1859). Key Reforms/Initiatives: Establishment of universities at Calcutta, Madras, and Bombay (1857). Passed War Rearmament Act (1856), managed the Revolt of 1857, and enacted the Act of 1858, dissolving the East India Company; Indian Councils Act (1861); a significant constitutional development; introduced income tax for the first time in India.
Lord Elgin I (1862-1863)	Key Events & Wars: Wahabi Movement (revolts against British rule)
Lord John Lawrence (1864-1869)	Key Events & Wars: Bhutan War (1865) Key Reforms/Initiatives: Set up High Courts at Calcutta, Bombay, and Madras (1865). Improved telegraphic communication with Europe, expanded canals and railways.
Lord Mayo (1869-1872)	Key Events & Wars: Opening of Rajkot College; Establishment of Statistical Survey of India Key Reforms/Initiatives: Department of Agriculture and Commerce established; Introduction of state railways. Financial decentralisation, establishment of Mayo College, and organised the Statistical Survey of India. The only Viceroy assassinated in office.
Lord Northbrook (1872-1876)	Key Events & Wars: Visit of Prince of Wales (1875); Trial of Gaekwar of Baroda; Kuka Movement.
Lord Lytton (1876-1880)	Key Events & Wars: Famine of 1876-78; Second Afghan War (1878-1880) Key Reforms/Initiatives: Royal Titles Act (1876); Vernacular Press Act (1878); Arms Act (1878). Abolished duties on British goods, held the Grand Durbar in Delhi during famine.
Lord Ripon (1880-1884)	Key Events & Wars: First Factory Act (1881); Continuation of financial decentralisation Key Reforms/Initiatives: Repeal of Vernacular Press Act (1882), Factory Reforms (1881), Ilbert Bill Debate (1883): Indian judges, British offenders, opposition, reintroduced (1884). Local Self-Government (1882). Educational Reforms: Hunter Commission, 1882 Land and Tenancy Reforms: Rent Commission, peasant unrest, Bengal Tenancy Act (1885). Economic Reforms: Financial decentralisation, revenue categorization, provincial control.
Lord Dufferin (1884-1888)	Key Events & Wars: Third Burmese War (1885-1886) Key Reforms/Initiatives: Establishment of the Indian National Congress (1885); Oversaw the annexation of Burma.
Lord Lansdowne (1888-1894)	Key Events & Wars: Second Factory Act (1891); Indian Councils Act (1892); Formation of Durand Commission (1893)

Lord Elgin II (1894-1899)	Key Events & Wars: Famine (1896-1897); Plague (1897) and Assassination of Rand by Chapekar brothers
Lord Curzon (1899-1905)	Key Events & Wars: Curzon-Kitchener Clash: Military authority dispute; Curzon resigns (1905); Younghusband Expedition (1904): Military mission to Tibet. Partition of Bengal (1905): Divided region; Hindu resistance; reversed (1911). Key Reforms/Initiatives: Agriculture Reform: Punjab Land Alienation Act (1900): Limits land transfer to money-lenders; Co-operative Credit Societies Act (1904): Supports peasants against high-interest loans. Scott Moncrieff Commission (1901): ₹4.5 crore for irrigation. Economic Reform: Currency: British currency legal tender; ₹15 = £1. Salt Tax: Reduced rate. Commerce & Industry Dept: Oversees industrial interests. Judicial Reforms: Calcutta High Court: More judges; higher salaries. Army Reforms: Reorganisation: Northern/Southern Commands; increased spending. Kitchener Test: Army assessment. Railways: Railway Commission (1901): Extended lines; established Railway Board. Famine Response: MacDonnell Commission: Employment for wages; tax relief. • Post-Famine Investigation: Recommends preventive measures. Key Acts/Commissions • Calcutta Corporation Act (1899): Reduced elected officials. • Police Commission (1902): Police reforms; Indian appointments. • Universities Commission (1902): University oversight. • Indian Universities Act (1904): Government control over universities. • Monuments Act (1904): Archaeological preservation.
Lord Minto II (1905-1910)	Key Events & Wars: Foundation of Muslim League (1906); Surat Split of Congress (1907) Key Reforms/Initiatives: Morley-Minto Reforms or Indian Councils Act (1909).
Lord Hardinge II (1910-1916)	Key Events & Wars: Transfer of capital to Delhi (1911) and Delhi Darbar (1911); Bomb attack on Viceroy (1912); Komagata Maru incident (1914)
Lord Chelmsford (1916-1921)	Key Events & Wars: Lucknow Pact (1916); Champaran Satyagraha (1917) Montagu Declaration (1917) - Kheda Satyagraha (1918); Rowlatt Act (1919) and Jallianwala Bagh massacre (1919). Key Reforms/Initiatives: Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms (1919).
Lord Reading (1921-1926)	Key Events & Wars: Moplah Rebellion (1921); Chauri Chaura incident (1922); Kakori Train Robbery (1925)
Lord Irwin (1926-1931)	Key Events & Wars: Simon Commission (1927); Nehru Report (1928) Deepavali Declaration (1929) - Civil Disobedience Movement (1930); First Round Table Conference (1930)
Lord Willingdon (1931-1936)	Key Events & Wars: Second Round Table Conference (1931) - Poona Pact (1932) - Formation of Congress Socialist Party (1934) Key Reforms/Initiatives: Communal Award and Gandhi's protest fast (1932).
Lord Linlithgow (1936-1943)	Key Events & Wars: Third Round Table Conference (1932); Second World War (1939); Lahore Resolution (1940); Cripps Mission (1942); Quit India Movement August Offer (1940); Key Reforms/Initiatives: Longest-serving Viceroy; declared India at war without consulting Congress.
Lord Wavell (1943-1947)	Key Events & Wars: INA Trials (1945); Simla Conference (1945); Wavell Plan and Simla Conference (1945). Cabinet Mission (1946); Direct action day (1948); end of World war 2(1945).
Lord Mountbatten (1947)	Key Events & Wars: Partition of India; Independence of India (15 August 1947); Last Viceroy; facilitated partition and transfer of power.

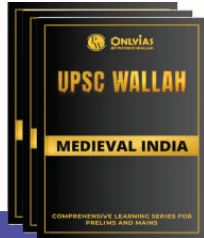
FOREIGN CONTRIBUTORS TO INDIA'S FREEDOM STRUGGLE

- **Annie Besant**, born in London on October 1, 1847, was associated with the **Theosophical Society** and arrived in India in 1893. She promoted Hinduism and Theosophy, founded the **Home Rule League** with Lokmanya Tilak in 1916, and established the Central Hindu School in Benaras, which later became **Banaras Hindu University**. Advocating for self-rule, she spread her ideas through publications like *New India* and *Commonweal* and presided over the 1917 Congress session. [UPSC 2013]
- **Charles Freer Andrews**, known as the “English friend of the freedom struggle,” was a British priest and ally of Gandhi. He convinced Gandhi to return to India in 1915, supported the **Vaikom Satyagraha (1919)**, and helped B.R. Ambedkar formulate Dalit demands (1933). Andrews also assisted Gandhi in negotiations at the Second London Round Table Conference, earning the title “**Dinbandhu**” for his compassion for the poor.
- **Madeleine Slade**, or Mirabehn, daughter of a British admiral, joined Gandhi's Sabarmati Ashram in 1925 and defended India's independence internationally. She attended the 1931 **London Round Table Conference**, promoted non-violence, and was arrested during the civil disobedience movement. In 1981, she received the **Padma Vibhushan**.
- **Satyananda Stokes** (Samuel Evans Stokes), an American inspired by the Jallianwala Bagh Massacre, joined the Indian freedom struggle and was imprisoned. He introduced **apple cultivation in Himachal Pradesh** and promoted education.
- **Sister Nivedita** (Margaret Elizabeth Noble), an Irish follower of **Swami Vivekananda**, supported women's education and nationalism, participated in the Swadeshi Movement, criticised British racial policies, and worked during famines.
- **Alfred Webb**, an Irish associate of Dadabhai Naoroji, was the **third non-Indian to preside over the Indian National Congress (INC)**, and emphasised the economic drain by the British.
- **George Yule**, a British national and **first non-Indian to preside over the INC**, advocated legislative reforms and broader representation in councils.
- **William Wedderburn**, a Scottish civil servant, focused on hunger, poverty, and agricultural credit. He entered the British Parliament as a Liberal MP in 1893 and formed the **Indian Parliamentary Committee** to support Indian issues.
- **Margaret Cousins**, born in Ireland in 1878, founded the **Women's India Association (WIA)** in 1917, campaigned for women's voting rights in 1919, launched Kamaladevi Chattopadhyay's Madras Legislative Council campaign, and set the tune for Rabindranath Tagore's *Jana Gana Mana*, India's national anthem.

Note: **Alexander Rea, A.H. Longhurst, Robert Sewell, James Burgess, and Walter Elliot** were notable figures involved in **archaeological excavations**. Alexander Rea, a British archaeologist, focused his work in southern British India and is recognized for discovering a sarcophagus in the hillocks of Pallavaram, Tamil Nadu. Albert Henry Longhurst, also a British archaeologist and art historian, conducted significant work in both India and Ceylon. He was the brother-in-law of **Sir John Marshall**, who served as the **Director-General of the Archaeological Survey of India** from 1902 to 1928. In October 1913, Longhurst was appointed Superintendent of the Archaeological Survey of India's Southern Circle. [UPSC 2023]

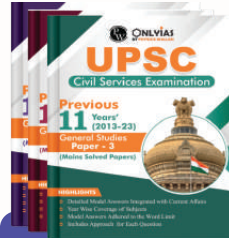


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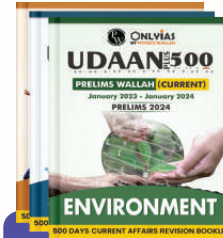
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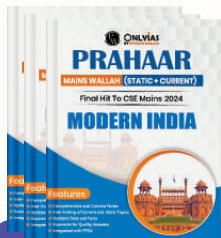
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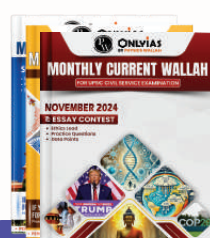
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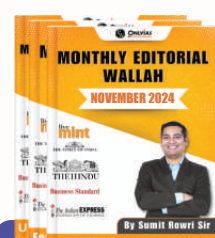
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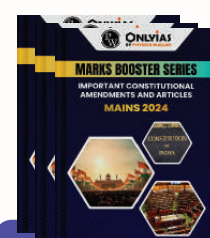
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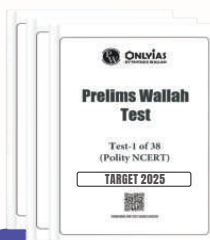
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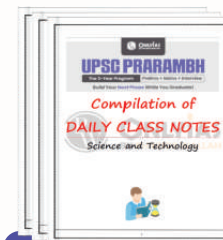
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